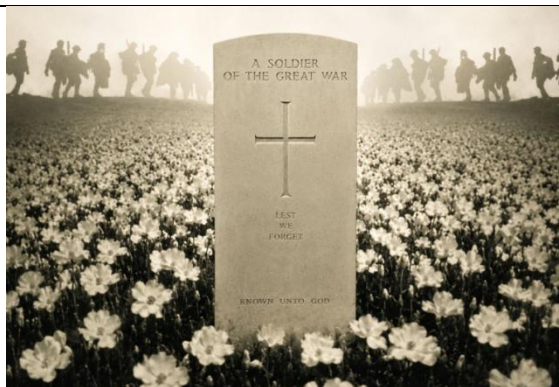




Thomas Edward Lion

1895 – 1915

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Thomas Edward Lion	CWGC
Date of Birth	23/1/1895 Born Stanmore	Baptism register (see below) baptism was in 1902 at St Martin in the Fields 1911 census
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	28/9/1915	CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	20	CWGC
Marital Status		
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	In 1911 he was working as a Junior Clerk aged 16. The Roll of Honour states he worked for the Royal Mail Steam Packet Co	1911 census De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour (see below)

Parents	Only son of Juan Joaquin Lion and Anna Lion, of 27, Broadhurst Gardens, Hampstead. Father was a widower in 1911 census	CWGC 1911 census
Listed Address(s)	Leslie Cottages, Old Church Lane, Stanmore Park Nursery, Old Church Lane, Stanmore	1911 census 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Nurseryman (on his own account) – Park Nursery, Stanmore. In 1902 he is described as a florist on his son's baptism entry	Censuses and Baptism register
Brothers and Sisters	Jeannette Helen Lion (older)	
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	Haven't found one but see Roll of Honour below	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	His CWGC gravestone	https://londonwarmemorial.co.uk/view_profile.php?id=15709
	John Lyon School, sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/341303
	John Lyon School, plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340985
	St John the Evangelist Churchyard, Stanmore	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/251080 with image of gravestone. Added to his mother's gravestone, he's actually buried in France
	Royal Mail Steam Packet Company WW1 memorial (Chatham)	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/41060

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	LION T.E.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/63609/lion,-thomas-edward/
Age	20
DoD	28-Sep-15
Rank	Pte
Regiment	Royal Army Medical Corps 3rd (London) Field Amb
Organisations must have served or have members who served in the Ypres Salient or the Somme in World War One.	BETHUNE TOWN CEMETERY
Location	BETHUNE TOWN CEMETERY France
Military details	Only son of Juan Joaquin Lion and Anna Lion, of 27, Broadhurst Gardens, Hampstead, London. Private Thomas Edward Lion (Service Number 265) of the 3rd (London) Field Ambulance, Royal Army Medical Corps (RAMC), was killed in action on September 28, 1915, at the age of 20. He was killed on the Western Front at Vermelles, near Loos-en-Gohelle in the Pas-de-Calais region of northern France. His death occurred during the catastrophic Battle of Loos (September 25 – October 13, 1915), which was the largest British offensive on the Western Front in 1915. Unlike many RAMC personnel who succumbed to illness or died at base hospitals, Private Lion was killed in action while stretcher-bearing on the battlefield. On September 28, the fourth day of the intense Battle of Loos, his medical unit was tasked with evacuating a staggering volume of casualties directly from the frontline trenches under relentless German fire. Private Lion was killed instantly alongside two fellow RAMC medics—Private Kenneth Charles Goodyear (Service Number 345) and Private George Kraninger (Service Number 120)—while actively carrying or treating a wounded soldier under fire. He is buried at Bethune Town Cemetery in France, which was used heavily by the field ambulances and casualty clearing stations operating in the Loos sector. He was the only son of Juan Joaquin Lion. His parents later paid tribute to him with an addition to their family gravestone in the UK, which explicitly notes his age, date of death, and that he was killed in action in France.

Story of Sacrifice

Thomas Edward Lion (1895 – 1915)

Thomas Edward Lion worked for the Royal Mail Steam Packet Company before volunteering for the Royal Army Medical Corps in September 1914. He served as a stretcher-bearer in France and died aged 20 from wounds sustained during the Battle of Loos on 28 September 1915.

Civilian Life

Thomas was born at Stanmore on 23 January 1895 and was baptised in 1902 at St Martin-in-the-Fields. His parents were American, his father was born in Puerto Rico and his mother in Philadelphia (1901 census). Her maiden name was Boehmer. They married in 1893 in Paddington registration district.. His father was a nurseryman and florist at Park Nursery in Stanmore. Thomas had an elder sister, Jeannette Helen. He was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow-on-the-Hill, and by 1911, aged 16, was working as a junior clerk. Before the war, he became a member of the staff of the Royal Mail Steam Packet Company.

Military Life

After the outbreak of the First World War, Thomas volunteered for the Royal Army Medical Corps (Territorial Force), joining on 5 September 1914. He served as a Private, service number 265, with the 3rd City of London Field Ambulance, RAMC. He went to France on 16 January 1915 and served with a field ambulance unit on the Western Front. He was killed on the Western Front at Vermelles, near Loos-en-Gohelle in the Pas-de-Calais region of northern France. His death occurred during the catastrophic Battle of Loos (September 25 – October 13, 1915), which was the largest British offensive on the Western Front in 1915. Unlike many RAMC personnel who succumbed to illness or died at base hospitals, Private Lion was killed in action while stretcher-bearing on the battlefield. On September 28, the fourth day of the intense Battle of Loos, his medical unit was tasked with evacuating a staggering volume of casualties directly from the frontline trenches under relentless German fire. Private Lion was killed instantly alongside two fellow RAMC medics—Private Kenneth Charles Goodyear (Service Number 345) and Private George Kraninger (Service Number 120)—while actively carrying or treating a wounded soldier under fire. He is buried at Bethune Town Cemetery in France, which was used heavily by the field ambulances and casualty clearing stations operating in the Loos sector.

Thomas was 20 years old. His section officer wrote: "He was one of those upon whom one could always rely to undertake any duty at any time and to do it well and cheerfully, and with good will. He was one of those competent men in whom his officers always had confidence, and they were never disappointed. He died gallantly in this battle, being hit by a shell in the trenches at the very outset, and died the same night in the Field Hospital. Two other members of his stretcher squad were killed at his side. He fell doing his duty and after having done it well for many months"; and a friend: "He was a fine fellow in every sense of the word, always ready to do anything, and there is not a man in the Corps that was not cut up about it."

He was buried at Bethune Town Cemetery in France. His death is recorded as 28 September 1915, and he is commemorated on memorials associated with John Lyon School and the Royal Mail Steam Packet Company. His parents later paid tribute to him with an addition to their family gravestone in the UK, which explicitly notes his age, date of death, and that he was killed in action in France.

Photo



Lion Photo Original



Lion Photo AI

Notes and Clippings

Background – parents were American with father born in Puerto Rico and his mother in Philadelphia (1901 census). Her maiden name was Boehmer. His mother died 31/5/1910
Parents married in 1893 in Paddington registration district

Baptism at St Martin in the Fields confirms birth date

23 rd January 1895	1890 pt April No 24	Thomas Edward	Juan Joaquin + Anna	Lion	Stannmore Middle	Horist J.A. Garton
-------------------------------------	------------------------------	------------------	------------------------------	------	---------------------	--------------------

The Roll of Honour

227

176607, H.M.S. Good Hope ;
v. 1914.

py., Forth Royal Garrison
: of the late James Lindsay,
in (Edzell Lodge, Inverleith
, dau. of James Harper, of
inburgh, 15 April, 1885;
stitution; was a partner in
say & Son, Cannon Mills,
the R.G.A. as 2nd Lieut.
Lieut., 1909, and Captain,
called up on the outbreak
14, and died in Craigleith
Edinburgh, 24 June, 1915,
injuries received in a motor
service; *unn.* He was
baller and played for the
ion F.P.'s. for ten years,
; captain of the team, and
ay he was elected to the
on, of which body he was
is death. He took great
lery work, and took his
as qualified to shoot for

, 4th Battn. King's Royal

LION, THOMAS EDWARD, Private, No. 265, 3rd City of London Field Ambulance, R.A.M.C. (T.F.), only s. of Juan Joaquin Lion, of 28, Frogna, Hampstead, N.W., Agent, by his wife, Anna, dau. of Henry Boehmer; b. Stanmore, co. Middlesex, 23 Jan. 1895; educ. Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow-on-the-Hill; was a member of the staff of the Royal Mail Steam Packet Co.; volunteered and joined the R.A.M.C. (T.F.), after the outbreak of war, 5 Sept. 1914; went to France, 16 Jan. 1915, and died at a Field Hospital, 28 Sept. 1915, of wounds received during the Battle of Loos. Buried in Bethune Cemetery. His section officer wrote:



Thomas Edward Lion.

"He was one of those upon whom one could always rely to undertake any duty at any time and to do it well and cheerfully, and with good will. He was one of those competent men in whom his officers always had confidence, and they were never disappointed. He died gallantly in this battle, being hit by a shell in the trenches at the very outset, and died the same night in the Field Hospital. Two other members of his stretcher squad were killed at his side. He fell doing his duty and after having done it well for many months"; and a friend: "He was a fine fellow in every sense of the word, always ready to do anything, and there is not a man in the Corps that was not cut up about it."

The Roll of Honour 227

LION, THOMAS EDWARD, Private, No. 265, 3rd City of London Field Ambulance, R.A.M.C. (T.F.), only s. of Juan Joaquin Lion, of 28, Frogna, Hampstead, N.W., Agent, by his wife, Anna, dau. of Henry Boehmer; b. Stanmore, co. Middlesex, 23 Jan. 1895; educ. Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow-on-the-Hill; was a member of the staff of the Royal Mail Steam Packet Co.; volunteered and joined the R.A.M.C. (T.F.), after the outbreak of war, 5 Sept. 1914; went to France, 16 Jan. 1915, and died at a Field Hospital, 28 Sept. 1915, of wounds received during the Battle of Loos. Buried in Bethune Cemetery. His section officer wrote: "He was one of those upon whom one could always rely to undertake any duty at any time and to do it well and cheerfully, and with good will. He was one of those competent men in whom his officers always had confidence, and they were never disappointed. He died gallantly in this battle, being hit by a shell in the trenches at the very outset, and died the same night in the Field Hospital. Two other members of his stretcher squad were killed at his side. He fell doing his duty and after having done it well for many months"; and a friend: "He was a fine fellow in every sense of the word, always ready to do anything, and there is not a man in the Corps that was not cut up about it."

From the Centenary issue of the Lyonia, researched by pupils 2014	
Lion, T E Thomas Lion died in action on 29th September in Bethune (NE France), aged 20. He was hit by a shell in the trenches. Note: Date of Death incorrect, should be 28th as confirmed by obituary and CWGC	From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian, researched by pupils 2014students Lion, T E Thomas Lion died in action on 29th (sic. 28th) September in Bethune (NE France), aged 20. He was hit by a shell in the trenches.